Sous Vide Chicken Breast

Main dishes | Sous vide

Before you start

Equipment: sous-vide bath, food-safe bag, and heavy skillet. Choose a temperature and matching cooking time from the source guide below. Skillet finish: about 2 minutes skin-side down.

Ingredients

Keep these ingredients separate; follow the order in the directions.

- [ ] 2 bone-in, skin-on chicken breast halves
- [ ] Kosher salt and black pepper
- [ ] 4 sprigs thyme or rosemary, optional
- [ ] Oil for finishing in a skillet

Source temperature guide

140°F: very soft and juicy, 1 1/2-4 hours

150°F: tender and juicy, 1-4 hours

160°F: traditional, firm and juicy, 1-4 hours

1. Season and cook

1. Preheat the bath to your chosen setting from the source temperature guide.

2. Season 2 bone-in, skin-on chicken breast halves generously with kosher salt and black pepper. Bag with optional 4 thyme or rosemary sprigs.

3. Use the matching temperature and time: 140°F for 1 1/2-4 hours; 150°F for 1-4 hours; or 160°F for 1-4 hours.

2. Dry and sear

1. Remove chicken from the bag, discard herbs, and pat very dry.

2. For crisp skin, heat oil in a heavy skillet over medium-high heat. Sear skin-side down about 2 minutes, pressing the chicken flat for even contact.

3. Rest briefly. Remove bones if desired, slice, and serve.

Notes

Personal note from Recipe Index: 153°F for 1 hour.

The source gives a 1-4 hour range at 150°F and 160°F; 153°F is between those listed settings.